

AI Ideathon 2026 Final Pitch Guidelines

Each finalist team will have:

4 minutes for the pitch

3 minutes for judge Q&A

Your goal is to help the judges quickly understand the problem, your solution, what you built, how the technology works, and the future potential of the project.

Recommended 4 Minute Pitch Structure

1. Problem and Impact, 40 to 45 seconds

Clearly explain:

- What problem are you solving?
- Who faces this problem?
- Why is it important?
- What real world impact could your solution create?

Keep the problem specific and easy to understand.

2. Solution and Innovation, 40 to 45 seconds

Introduce your solution.

Explain:

- What did you build?
- How does it solve the problem?
- What makes your approach different?
- Why is AI useful or necessary in your solution?

Do not only say that your project uses AI. Explain what AI actually enables.

3. Product Demo, 60 to 75 seconds

Show the main functionality of your product.

Focus on one clear user journey:

User problem → User action → Product or AI process → Useful result

Show the strongest parts of your prototype.

Avoid spending too much time on login screens, menus, setup, or minor features.

4. Technical Implementation, 35 to 45 seconds

Briefly explain how the system works.

You may include:

- AI models or services used
- Main technologies
- Data sources
- Backend and frontend flow
- AI agents, RAG, automation, APIs, or other important components
- A simple architecture diagram

You do not need to explain every technical detail.

The judges should understand that the solution is functional, logical, and technically feasible.

5. Product Potential and Closing, 35 to 45 seconds

Explain where the project could go next.

Cover:

- Target users or customers
- Potential adoption
- Scalability
- Business or sustainability potential
- Future development
- Why this project can continue beyond the Ideathon

Finish with a strong closing statement that reminds the judges why your project matters.

Technical Architecture

Technical implementation accounts for **20 percent of the judging criteria**, so teams should be ready to explain how their system works.

An architecture diagram is encouraged if it helps explain the project clearly.

Keep it simple.

For example:

User → Application → AI System → Database or External Services → Result

Do not spend too much time discussing frameworks or technical terminology unless the technology itself is the main innovation.

Deeper technical questions can be addressed during the Q&A.

3 Minute Judge Q&A

With three minutes available for Q&A, teams should be prepared for judges to explore the project in more depth.

Possible questions may cover:

- Why you selected this problem
- Why your solution is different
- How the AI works
- Technical architecture
- Whether the prototype is functional
- Target users
- Competitors or alternatives
- Scalability
- Business model
- Limitations
- Future development

Keep answers clear, direct, and concise.

If different team members understand different areas, the most relevant member can answer each question.

Final Advice

Your pitch should balance all five judging areas:

Problem Fit and Real World Impact, 25%

Innovation and Idea Quality, 20%

Technical Implementation, 20%

Product Potential and Scalability, 20%

Demo and Presentation, 15%

Do not spend all four minutes only explaining the idea.

Do not spend all four minutes only showing the application.

Do not spend all four minutes explaining the technology.

A strong pitch connects:

**Why the problem matters → What you built → How it works → Why it is different →
Where it can go next**

Most importantly, make sure the judges clearly understand your project within four minutes.